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BSCS-2A
UTS

M6 - Reflective Essay

Reflect on your personal experiences and perspectives related to your Political and Spiritual Self. Use the questions below as a guide in developing a coherent, reflective essay. Integrate your responses into a unified, narrative essay, providing detailed explanations and examples.

A. Political Self

How would you describe your political self? What political values and beliefs do you consider central to your identity, and why?

"I'm not very political, but my values are all the same, it's to ultimately "be kind" and I need to see others reflect that value in some form."

Which societal institution (school, church, peers, media) has significantly influenced your political beliefs? Provide an example of how these institutions shaped your political views.

"I would say social media has significantly influenced my political beliefs. Recently more and more political Tiktok videos are appearing on my feed and there have been plenty of news of the younger generations speaking out against the evils of the Philippine government and generally that's how I'd be informed about our politics."

Reflecting on your political socialization, have your political beliefs changed over time? What experiences or factors prompted these changes?

"The only political belief I have is that I'd never forgive people in power abusing their power in ways that cause harm to others and there isn't much that is going to change that belief."

B. Spiritual Self

How would you define your spiritual self? What beliefs or practices give meaning and purpose to your life?

"I am a Christian Catholic but I'm not religious whatsoever, I don't attend mass or do any sort of service for the church. However I think it's always good to have something to believe in, because If you don't then what's the point of anything? "

What role does spirituality or religion play in your personal identity and decision-making process? Share a specific experience when your spiritual values guided your choices.

"I don't think about religion much, so it doesn't even come to mind when decision-making. As much as possible I'd like to just go with the flow with things and react accordingly."

Which influences (family, religious community, school, personal experiences) most strongly shaped your spiritual identity? Provide an example of how this influence affected your spiritual growth.

I have many friends that go to church and are very religious, even inviting me over to attend one of their masses. I think that I'd like to experience other religions at some point in my life.

How do your spiritual beliefs help you cope with life's challenges? Describe a situation when your spiritual values provided you comfort, resilience, or guidance.

Even though I'm not very religious, I believe that faith isn't just about prayer or believing in a higher being but rather about trusting that things will work out in time. I remember not thinking our hackathon idea would be anywhere close to winning even in the Top 3 but we turned out to be the Top 1 somehow and I'm really grateful for that.